

Emotion Snapshot Audit Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	emotion-snapshot-audit

Big idea: Emotion is not merely noise in knowing; it can focus, filter, and frame evidence.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students interpret the same ambiguous scene under different emotional states and compare how feeling directs attention.

Student Prompt

Inspect Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Scene: a student sees two friends whispering and laughing near the classroom door. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Emotion frames: anxious, excited, suspicious, calm, embarrassed, proud. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Emotion Snapshot Audit Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Emotion frames: anxious, excited, suspicious, calm, embarrassed, proud. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Emotion is not merely noise in knowing; it can focus, filter, and frame evidence.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	How does emotion shape what knowers notice?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how emotion is not merely noise in knowing; it can focus, filter, and frame evidence.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: How does emotion shape what knowers notice?

Setup Checklist

- Use fictional emotion cards rather than asking students to disclose their actual mood.
- Choose an ambiguous image or short scene with several plausible interpretations.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Scene: a student sees two friends whispering and laughing near the classroom door.
- Emotion frames: anxious, excited, suspicious, calm, embarrassed, proud.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/emotion-snapshot-audit/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/emotion-snapshot-audit/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/emotion-snapshot-audit/visual-prompt.svg>
- Emotion frame cards with noticing prompts.
- Interpretation grid: detail noticed, inference, emotion frame, evidence strength.

Run Sequence

1. Show students the same ambiguous stimulus without discussion.
2. Assign groups different emotion frame cards.
3. Groups list what details they notice, what they infer, and what they ignore.
4. Compare interpretations across emotion frames.
5. Debrief emotion as evidence, filter, and interpretive context.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: How does emotion shape what knowers notice?
- Can emotion improve knowledge by making some evidence salient?

- When does emotional interpretation become distortion?

Teacher Quick Script

- Emotion did not add new visual evidence, but it changed which details mattered.
- When might emotion help you notice something important?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...